



Endangerment: history, education, and ideology

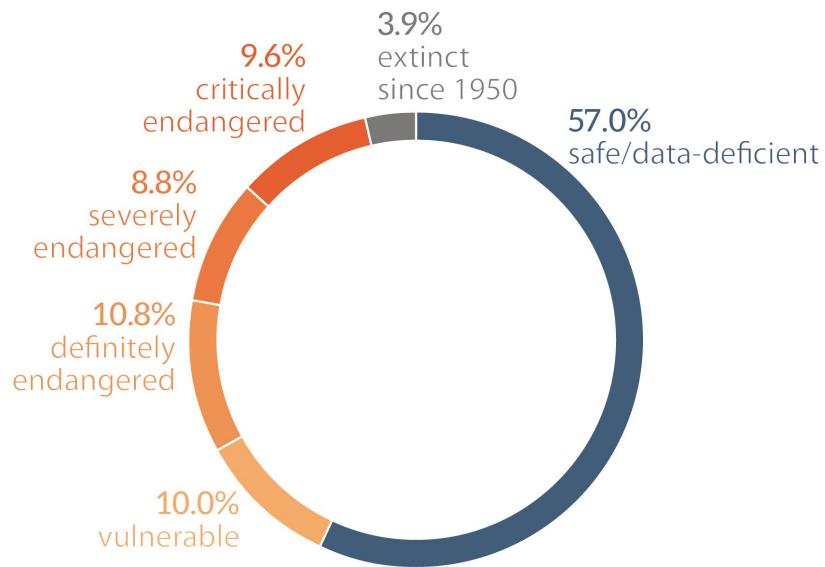
Ling 97R Sophomore Tutorial [Spring 2024]

Instructor: Yvette Yi-Chi Wu

check-in about presentations

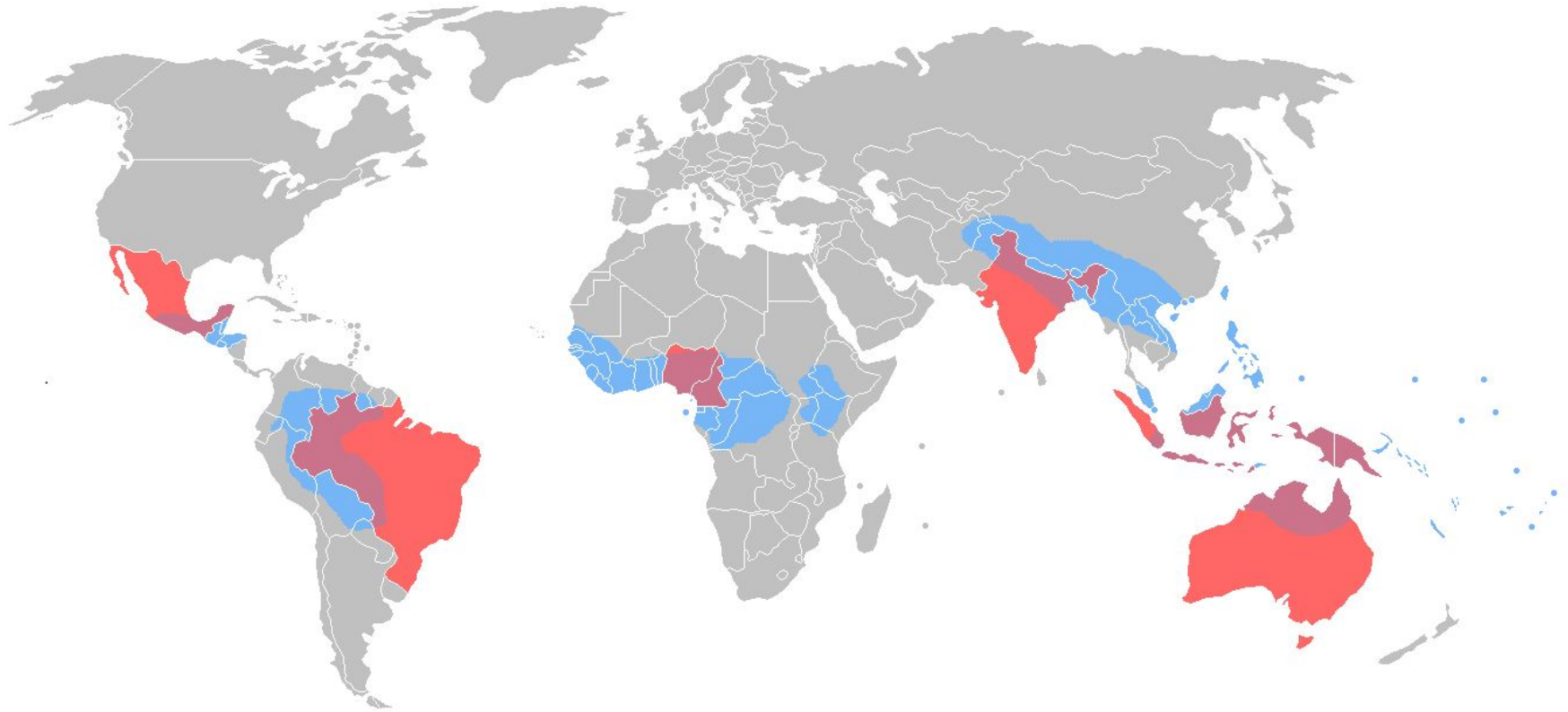
languages of the world today

- ~7,000 languages in the world
- scientists predict 90% of the world's language will become dormant within a century (Bromham et al. 2021)
- the top 10 languages are spoken by ~70% of the world (Ethnologue)



Data source: Federal Union of European Nationalities

EPRS | European Parliamentary Research Service



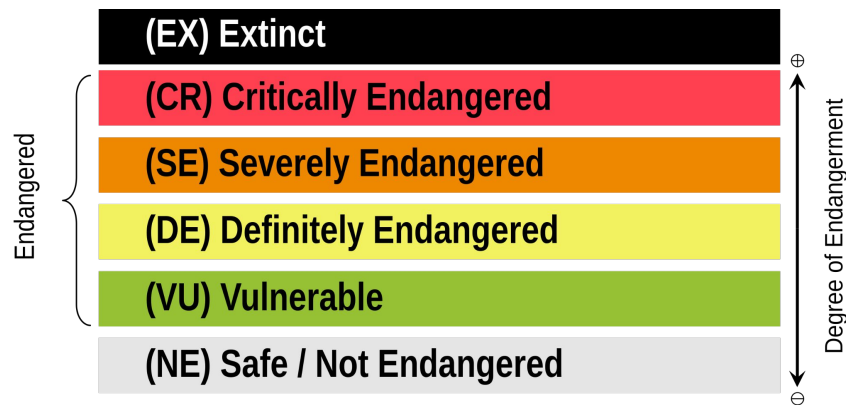
Wikipedia: 50% of the world's endangered languages are in 8 countries (red)
coincides with the most linguistically diverse places in the world (blue)



how UNESCO classifies language vitality

nine factors in determination (2003):

1. intergenerational language transmission
2. absolute number of speakers
3. proportion of speakers within total population
4. trends in existing language domains
5. response to new domains and media
6. materials for education and literacy
7. governmental and institutional language attitudes and policies
8. community members' attitudes
9. amount and quality of documentation





domains of use



- **school:** language(s) of instruction in K-12 and higher education



- **home:** language(s) spoken to family members, e.g. parents, grandparents



- **public:** language(s) spoken in public spaces, e.g. market, hospitals



- **work:** language(s) (spoken and written) in work environment



- **peers:** language(s) spoken with friends and partners



- **entertainment:** language(s) of music, movies/shows, books, etc.



- **technology:** language(s) used on devices and on the internet



**we will discuss four
(interrelated) factors
that lead to language
endangerment:**

1. colonialism and forced assimilation
2. globalization and urbanization
3. political and climate displacement
4. attitudes towards language and culture

**factor #1: colonialism
and forced assimilation**

settler colonialism

- disease and genocide
- dispossession and displacement
- forced assimilation
- resource deprivation
- disruption of knowledge transmission

INDIAN LAND FOR SALE

GET A HOME
OF
YOUR OWN
*
EASY PAYMENTS



PERFECT TITLE
*
POSSESSION
WITHIN
THIRTY DAYS

FINE LANDS IN THE WEST

IRRIGATED GRAZING AGRICULTURAL
IRRIGABLE DRY FARMING

IN 1910 THE DEPARTMENT OF THE INTERIOR SOLD UNDER SEALED BIDS ALLOTTED INDIAN LAND AS FOLLOWS:

Location.	Acres.	Average Price per Acre.	Location.	Acres.	Average Price per Acre.
Colorado	5,211.21	\$7.27	Oklahoma	34,664.00	\$19.14
Idaho	17,013.00	24.85	Oregon	1,020.00	15.43
Kansas	1,684.50	33.45	South Dakota	120,445.00	16.53
Montana	11,034.00	9.86	Washington	4,879.00	41.37
Nebraska	5,641.00	36.65	Wisconsin	1,069.00	17.00
North Dakota	22,610.70	9.93	Wyoming	865.00	20.64

FOR THE YEAR 1911 IT IS ESTIMATED THAT **350,000 ACRES** WILL BE OFFERED FOR SALE

For information as to the character of the land write for booklet, "INDIAN LANDS FOR SALE," to the Superintendent U. S. Indian School at any one of the following places:

CALIFORNIA: Hesperia COLORADO: Durango IDAHO: Lapwai KANSAS: Horton Nadeau	MINNESOTA: Ojibwa MONTANA: Crow Agency NEBRASKA: Macy Santee Winnebago	NORTH DAKOTA: Fort Totten Fort Yates OKLAHOMA: Anadarko Cantonment Colony Darlington Muskogee Pawnee	OREGON: Klamath Agency Pendleton Roseburg Siletz Tillamook	SOUTH DAKOTA: Sax and Fox Agency Sioux Wynandott WASHINGTON: Cheyenne Agency Crow Creek Greenwood Lower Brule Pine Ridge Rosebud Sisseton	WASHINGTON: Fort Simcoe Fort Spokane Tulalip WISCONSIN: Gould Sisseton
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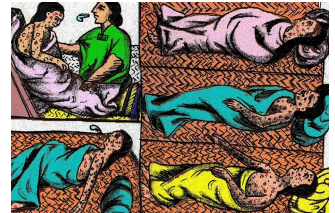
WALTER L. FISHER,
Secretary of the Interior.

ROBERT G. VALENTINE,
Commissioner of Indian Affairs.

“If ethnolinguistic nationalism presaged state-formation, and if a nation could be thought of in terms of the triad blood-soil-language, with language being the most important, then the Indigenous peoples, by European standards, clearly were nations. Seen this way, Indigenous languages linked People to Land. This connection between Native people and land had to be disarticulated. Disarticulation required the destruction of language.”

- Malathi Michelle Iyengar, *Language policies and language ideologies in U.S. settler colonialism*

U.S. context:



US Context: Aufderheide, Rodríguez-Martín & Langsjoen (1998), McKenna & Pratt (2015), Hadden (2019)

disease and genocide: by 1900, smallpox, measles or flu killed an estimated 90% of Native Americans, others by slavery, genocide, sterilization

dispossession and displacement: tribes from the East were forcibly moved to reservations in the West, Indian Removal Act of 1830

forced assimilation: children forced to attend residential schools and forbidden from speaking their languages, cultural and religious indoctrination

resource deprivation: poor access to housing, food, water, healthcare, education, economic opportunities, due to systemic infrastructural issues

disruption of knowledge transmission: all of the above contributed to erasure of oral histories, place-based knowledge, cultural and linguistic practices

Wopanaak

Mashpee Wampanoag Tribe website, Plimoth Patuxet Museums website, Portalewska (2015)

- ~40,000 people prior to 16th century contact
~4,500 modern day descendants and enrolled citizens
- endemic between 1616 and 1619 due to smallpox and/or leptospirosis due to rat population on European ships
- conversion to Christianity and changes in gender roles
- King Phillip's War (1675): resistance led by alliance of native tribes, deadliest war between colonial and native forces, destruction of native villages and mass execution
- 1700-1900s: forced resettlement to Mashpee, Martha's Vineyard, and Nantucket, denial of self-governance



Taiwan context:



Taiwan Context: Aufderheide, Rodríguez-Martín & Langsjoen (1998), McKenna & Pratt (2015), Hadden (2019)

a series of colonizing forces: Dutch, Spanish, Japanese, and Chinese

dispossession and displacement: tribes pushed out of the plains into the mountains by Chinese settlers, relocated by Japanese government

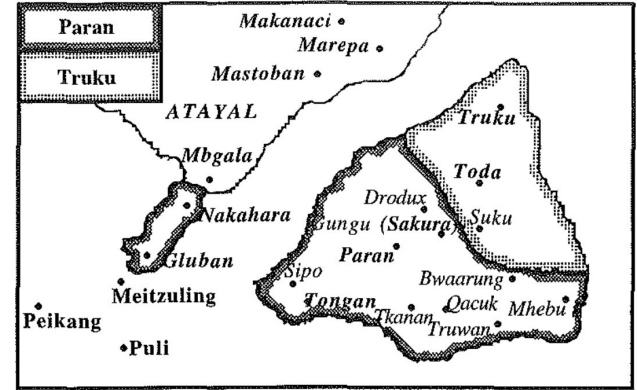
forced assimilation: non-Japanese or Mandarin languages prohibited from being spoken in the public sphere, cultural and religious indoctrination

resource deprivation: poor access to housing, food, water, healthcare, education, economic opportunities, due to systemic infrastructural issues

disruption of knowledge transmission: all of the above contributed to erasure of oral histories, place-based knowledge, cultural and linguistic practices

Seediq

- ~2,000 members of the Tgdaya tribe prior to Wushe
~800 modern members of relocated Gluban village
- Japanese colonial government (1895-1945) imposed forced labor and assimilation, military misconduct
- encouragement of conflict between Seediq tribes
- Wushe Incident (1930): resistance of the Tgdaya Seediq tribe kills Japanese officials, Japanese retaliate, resulting in ~1,000 murdered or committed suicide
- relocation to Gluban and separated from other tribes



**discussion: why is linguistic
oppression a common tool of
colonialism?**

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**factor #2: globalization
and urbanization**

social, cultural, and economic dominance

- availability of education and jobs to ensure economic survival and mobility
- stigma against non-dominant languages
- exporting of American culture: Hollywood, pop music and culture, food, technological products and appliances, etc.



media and technology

- access to technology:
fonts and keyboard,
translation, ChatGPT,
system language settings
- sources of entertainment,
social media, information,
business, e-commerce, etc.

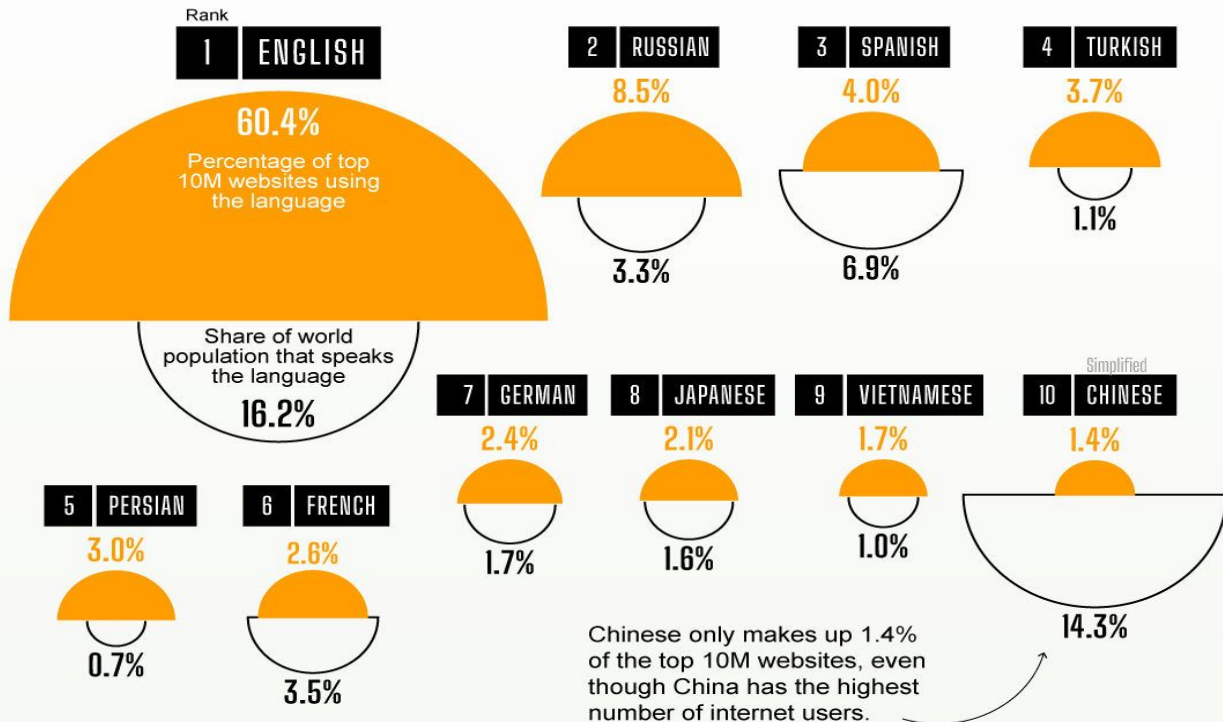


Most Commonly Used Languages

ON THE INTERNET



Here's a look at the most commonly used languages on the web, and how they compare to the world's population of speakers.



Taiwan context:

Some people want diamond rings

Some just want everything

But everything means nothing

If I ain't got you, yeah



iPhone 15 Pro Max
搶先上手體驗!

@Joeman

@Joeman

@Joeman

趕快去看一下
新的iPhone

那整個拿起來我體感覺
得至少輕了20~30克

就是全新的
iPhone 15 Pro Max

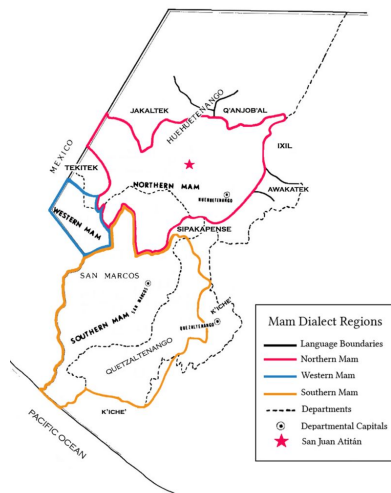


migration

- people move to new places in search of labor, stability, escape from poverty, etc.
- many move to cities that don't have institutional support for their languages
- **intermarriage** between speakers of different language is also a key factor in initiating shift to the dominant language



Mam context:



ANNALS OF IMMIGRATION

A TRANSLATION CRISIS AT THE BORDER

For migrants who speak Mayan languages, a grassroots group of interpreters is often their only hope for receiving asylum.

By Rachel Nolan

December 30, 2019



Table 1. Percentage of Children (Age 6–15) Who Speak Only English at Home, by Generation

Ethnicity	Second Generation		Third Generation		Mother-Tongue Homes: Third Generation	
	%	<i>N</i>	%	<i>N</i>	%	<i>N</i>
Chinese	29.4	6,130	91.4	1,494	69.4	330
Japanese	67.7	1,701	97.4	3,066	79.5	283
Korean	42.5	3,272	90.4	153	66.4	31
Filipino	79.3	7,108	95.7	1,759	73.1	247
Cuban	19.1	4,159	78.4	577	52.4	231
Dominican	8.4	2,489	51.5	109	26.5	70
Mexican	12.3	53,459	64.1	56,113	48.9	39,199

Alba et al. (2002): *Only English by the third generation? Loss and preservation of the mother tongue among the grandchildren of contemporary immigrants*

**discussion: how does
globalization affect the
domains of use for minority
languages?**

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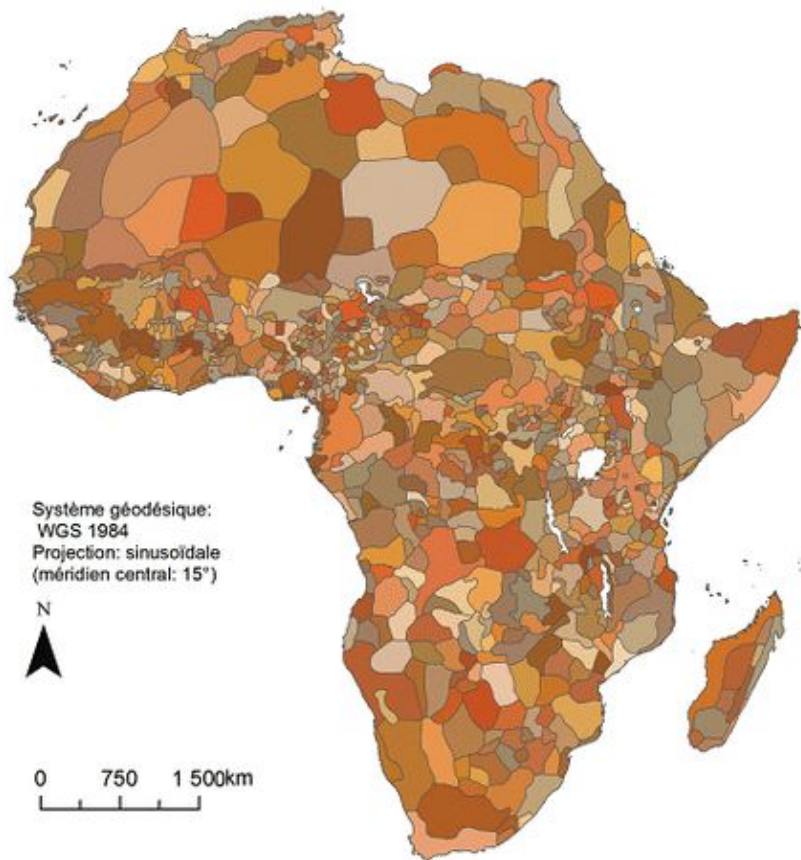
**factor #3: political
and climate displacement**

political conflict and violence

- violent conflict and war due to ethnic and religious tensions, military invasion, resource and territorial dispute, political unrest, etc.
- causes linguistic instability and fragmentation
- conflict can be over language repression itself, such as the Bangladesh Liberation Movement
- arbitrary borders clash with ethnic homelands



African
context:

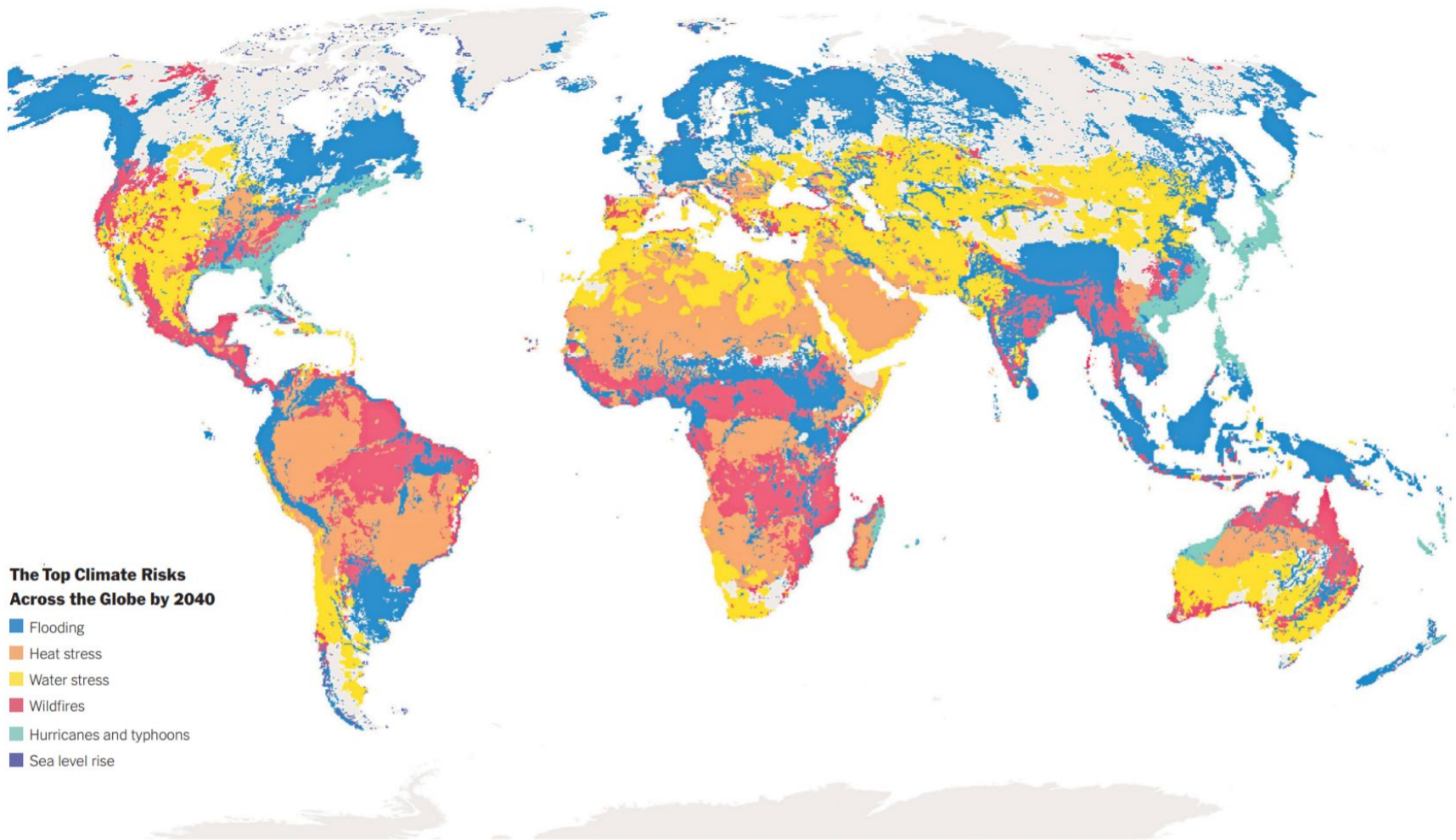


ethnic homelands vs. nation-state borders Michalopoulos and Papaioannou (2016)

climate change and “natural” disasters

- climate change affects food practices, spread of disease and plague, habitability, access to water and other resources, etc.
- for example, many small communities are located on islands or coasts, which are vulnerable to hurricanes or rising sea levels
- climate adaptation is resource intensive and requires technology and planning

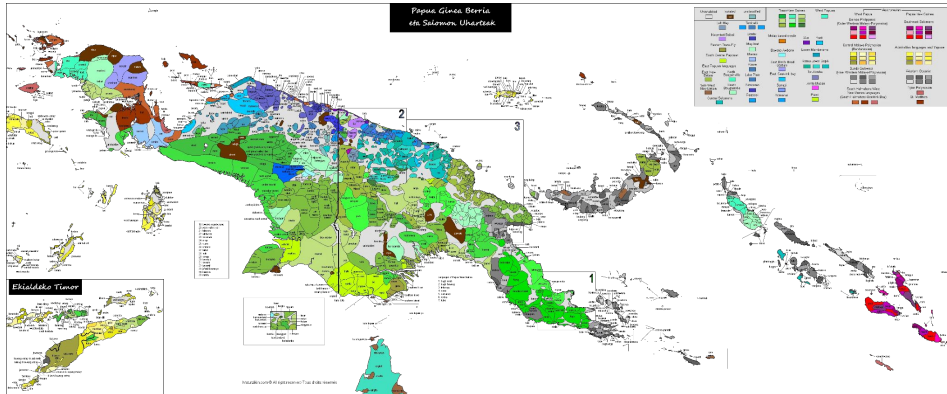




Papua New Guinea: Conflict and election-related violence trigger wave of displacement



New Guinea /
Papuan context:



**discussion: why does climate
change disproportionately
affect ethnic minorities and
under-resourced communities?**

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**factor #4: attitudes towards
language and culture**



prejudice against indigenous languages

- the idea that indigenous languages are rudimentary, cannot convey abstract ideas, and other prejudices, was and still is widespread
- put forth by early anthropologists in the United States to uphold a “pseudoscientific theory of racial and cultural hierarchy”
- ideas about the languages themselves or the people who speak them
- European-based ideologies of language and intellect, including the treatment of language as an asset or skill to be commodified

THE REAL EBONICS DEBATE

Power,
Language,
and the
Education of
African-American
Children

A SPECIAL ISSUE OF RETHINKING SCHOOLS
GUEST EDITED BY THERESA PERRY & LISA DELPIT

Rethinking Schools is pleased to present this special issue, *The Real Ebonics Debate: Language, Power, and the Education of African-American Children*. For the first time in the history of *Rethinking Schools*, guest editors have solicited and written the articles, and overseen editorial content from inception to implementation.

Perhaps more than any other debate in education, the study of language struggles with questions of

Power and Lisa Delpit approached *Rethinking Schools* with the proposal to guest edit this issue on Ebonics. Both are well-respected educators with a long history of challenging educational practices that are a dis-service to African-American students.

As Lisa Delpit notes in her article, one cannot be for or against Ebonics. It exists. It is the language many African-American children heard "as their mothers nursed them and observed their dreams and

did little to clarify the misunderstandings about the history of the language or to help educators develop curriculum. Delpit, Perry, and the other writers in this volume offer background history that excavates the race and power dynamics surrounding the development of the language, and discuss how an understanding of Ebonics may affect classroom practice. We believe it is especially important that white educators carefully consider their arguments.

MARCH 28, 2022 | 5 MIN READ

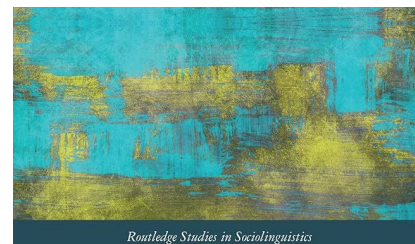
Anthropology Association Apologizes to Native Americans for the Field's Legacy of Harm

For decades anthropologists exploited Indigenous peoples in the name of science. Now they are reckoning with that history

Undoing Appropriateness: Raciolinguistic Ideologies and Language Diversity in Education

NELSON FLORES
University of Pennsylvania

JONATHAN ROSA
University of Massachusetts Amherst



Routledge Studies in Sociolinguistics

RACIALIZATION AND LANGUAGE

INTERDISCIPLINARY PERSPECTIVES FROM PERU

Edited by
Michele Back and Virginia Zavala



“Duponceau’s [1819] assertion that all Native American languages demonstrated polysynthesis was actually incorrect, but his attention to morpheme-word ratios had a lasting impact in linguistics. The term “polysynthetic” is still used today to describe languages with high morpheme-to-word ratios. For nineteenth century philologists, however, polysynthesis “was more than a description”; it entailed a value judgment about speakers’ levels of intellectual development. When Duponceau “announced his discovery that all American Indian languages appeared to demonstrate a uniform grammatical structure and underlying plan of thought” – i.e. polysynthesis – he “implied as well a single stage of mental development, thus subtly shifting the question of Indian identity from the realm of historical affinity to one of developmental stages” (Hinsley, 1981, p. 23). Following Duponceau, researchers increasingly deployed linguistic data to support the idea that the Natives represented some prior stage in a course of “development” through which Europeans had already passed.”

- Malathi Michelle Iyengar, *Language policies and language ideologies in U.S. settler colonialism*

Pirahã context:



LEXICON VALLEY

What Happens When a Language Has No Numbers?

BY MIKE VUOLO

OCT 16, 2013 • 2:00 PM



Articles / The Pirahã Language: A Language Without Color

The Pirahã Language: A Language Without Color



Hannah Silva

January 10, 2022



myths about language learning

- parents can be hesitant to speak to their children in their language or expose them to bilingual education even when available
- “can delay language development”, “it is confusing to the child”, “bilingual education is ineffective”, “leads to academic difficulties”
- years of scientific research has shown that multilingualism comes naturally to children



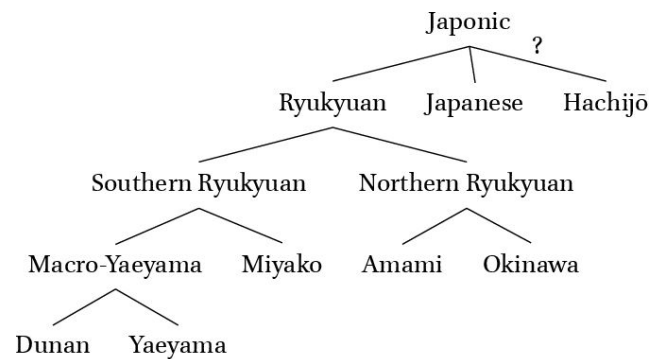
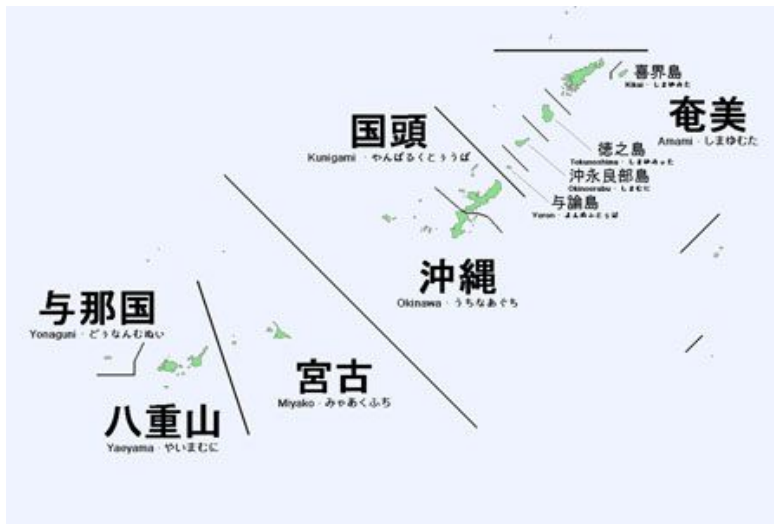
multilingualism is still valuable even if a child never becomes “fully fluent” and/or starts learning at an older age
→ it’s never too late!



ethno-nationalism and linguistic purism

- connection between language, intellect, and national identity
 - national progress based on and “linguistic progress”
- ties to scientific racism and the field of historical linguistics
- the nation-state as an imagined community Anderson (1983)
- Native American threatened the idea of a white nation state, if nation is constructed based off of race, language, and land

Ryukyuan context:



**discussion: why did the
United States transition into a
monolingual society?**

—



next week: student presentations

- guidelines posted on Canvas under Files
- 12-15 minutes long
- choose one language to present on
- we'll wrap up with a discussion of observations and common themes